

List of Apps

Category	Applications
Accessories	Bulk Rename, Calculator, Colour Folders, Conky, HJSplitX, Screenshot, Text Editor, Xpad
Graphics	Cheese, Get-Photos, GIMP, Inkscape, gThumb, XSane
Network/Internet	Check-Gmail, Firefox, gFTP, Pidgin, Thunderbird
Office	OpenOffice.org suite
Multimedia	AviDemux, Brasero, EasyTAG, Totem Media Player, Rhythmbox, Sound Converter, Sound Juicer, Sound Recorder, SPDIF Switch
System tools	Bluetooth Analyser, Dreamlinux Control Panel, Easy Install, Engage Admin, Install options, Process Viewer (htop)

Table 1

Rhythmbox for audio. I didn't have a problem playing any media files. I was even able to play my Blu-ray movies in their full glory, without any hiccups. The only problem was with playing midi and dat files. For your optical disc burning need, Brasero is installed.

In addition to basic applications, DL spices up the distro by adding its own home-made Ruby scripts for pumping up the experience. There are many scripts with easy-to-use GUIs to help you set up your system. Conky lovers get a pre-configured script to set up Conky, which is pretty handy. There is a Colour Folder script that changes colours with simple clicks.

For audio buffs there's an SPDIF redirecting switch. If you have a Dolby set-up you can easily use it with this SPDIF script. The icing on the cake is the Dreamlinux Easy Install and Control Panel. Easy Install acts as a *wget* wrapper, with few selected applications on board; all you need is to click on the application to install it (Figure 4). The only let down is that it installs older versions of software. Developers should have updated the easy install repositories with newer software. But you can expect some updates in the near future.

The Control Panel serves as a centralised hub to control major parts of the system (Figure 5). It consists of basic features like setting up a network, sharing folders, enabling composite windows, etc. A few exquisite features are AMD Cool 'n' Quite, Multiscreen set-up, etc. AMD CnC works only with the AMD K8/K10 series (or above) processors. This

is an energy efficient technology that reduces the multiplying of processors, thus lowering the speed and voltage required to operate when they are not needed, and saving quite a bit of electricity. You can always turn on this feature from the motherboard BIOS if this script fails to work.

A tool called HardInfo in the Control Panel lists your hardware, like *lshw*. HardInfo comes with an easy-to-use GUI as a bonus. It covers almost all system devices with decent information, and even lists temperatures from the system diode. Apart from this, it comes with a few benchmarking tools to test your system's power. Though there isn't much data to compare with, it's still good enough.

Since it is a Debian-based distro, you need not worry about package managers or searching for additional software. You can either install it from the vast Debian repositories, or you can grab software from TuxSoftware.com, a portal very similar to Linspire's Click-N-Run utility. One thing to note is that the default server is pretty slow. Even with my 512 KBps plan I don't get sufficiently good speed while installing applications.

You might be a bit disappointed if you plan to install deb files by double clicking on them—it opens the package using the archive manager. For some reason, *gdebi* is not associated with deb files. To associate deb files with *gdebi*, simply right click on the file and select the 'Open With Other Application' option. In the 'Use a custom command' box, paste the following *gdebi-gtk %f*. Make sure you check the 'Use as default

for this kind of files' option.

A few applications like the XBMC media centre application, Softmaker Office, OpenOffice.org 3.0, and GNOME, can be directly installed from the binary packages provided at the download page of Dreamlinux. XBMC is a very interesting player—take a look at Figure 6.

Time to get up!

Well, every distro has its ups and downs and so does Dreamlinux. The only problem I am facing is with my non-functioning scanner. Another problem that you are going to face is that the Synaptic package manager is not present in the applications menu. So, the only way to access it is by clicking the big *Apt-Get* icon on the Engage dock.

Anyway, the bottom line is: Dreamlinux is a distro with great potential! I really don't see a reason for not trying it. **ENG** 

Dreamlinux 3.5



Pros: Fast, uses low resources, easy to use, multimedia support, centralised Control Panel, Install Options..

Cons: Older software, No applications in menus, shabby hardware support

Platform: x86

Price: Free (as in beer)

Website: www.dreamlinux.org.br

Resources

- Home Page: <http://www.dreamlinux.com.br/>
- Release Notes: <http://www.dreamlinux.com.br/desktopedition.html>
- Forums: <http://www.dreamlinuxforums.org/>

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The author is a FOSS/hardware enthusiast who likes to review software and tweak his hardware for optimum performance. He's interested in Python, in Qt programming and is fond of benchmarking the latest FOSS distros.